

Poems

Morning Identities

Pink streaks and orange horizon
Amber rays shine upon my
Bundle of blankets
Eyes open as I wake and
My system is in full action
I get ready and my brain is bewildered
Staring at a weighted wardrobe
full of colors, shapes, and designs
This decision lays my whole day in front of me
Weather, style, comfort, and...
Personality
My clothes allow me to change my personality
 A dress,
elegant and a bit risky
Shorts,
 A stylish addition to any guise
Sweats,
 the spitting image of comfort
From now till night I could be a student,
party animal, procrastinator,
Or the person who just doesn't care
Who expresses themselves how they want to
I can choose anything, and I have,
But everyday I choose to dress somehow
different
But that doesn't change who
I AM

Rhea Madhogarhia

Ode to Jackets

Style

Warmth

Color

A plethora of things that make a jacket special

It comes in many shapes and sizes

Snowflakes

Each having their own personal flair

simple yet elegant

adding sophistication to any ensemble of snow;poiuytfdc

Coat

Sweater

Parka and more

Variety, trend, and designs galore

Strong,

like houses, containing people inside who are fortunate enough

Having a roof protecting them from rain, wind, shine

Some, without roofs, carry just as much dazzle

It's the one house everyone walks by and stares in awe

I put on my favorite one

Ziiiipp, ruffle ruffle

I fold up the sleeves to fit more appropriately, the weather

Of summer

If need be i slide it off and look just fine

But when i have my jacket on I feel more divine

It has been worn,

indeed torn

Lost, but maybe found

Hung up and seized down

Thousands of journeys it has endured

Each reminds me of a memory,

All the things I've been through,

Good....and bad

Nonetheless, their mine

Rhea Madhogarhia

Whether I find change in my pockets
a hole in my hood
Or a collar bent out of shape
My jacket will give me warmth in
even the darkest,
Happiest
Saddest
And brightest
Of times

Rhea Madhogarhia

Swan Amidst the World

Wings of an angel
Lay upon their shoulders as
They glide through water

Feathers
as long as their lissome necks
Its head resembling the half of a heart yet
Carrying the grace, elegance, and
love as a full one

Eyes,
Pitch black,
a glimmer like a diamond
amidst coal.
It sits like a pearl in the sea

Paddles not seen to the eye,
Making movement possible
without recognition

On the surface,
Composed.
Beneath, shows
diligent workers.

Making even an urban park lavish.
Boring to watch,
But what a glamorous lifestyle
Attending to its own needs
Yet still,
Caring for others.

confined to a pool of tranquility but
Allowed to venture,
Anywhere

The Mango Tango

Rhea Madhogarhia

Glowing red,

freckles of yellow

Fading down to an emerald green

a dress like feathers of a tropical bird

Brown scars and dents displaying every fall,

Scratch,

Bruise

Stamped with a colorful seal representing its country of Peru

As I move my fingers along with it, a

smooth sensation

Like a wax figure is sensed as I find my way through it

It's as soft as a bunny as I cut across the floor with it

I can see inside it as I dance and dance

With the sharpness of a knife.

Its emotion and soul pouring out in front of me

A round character with slight imperfections

A bright and happy feeling, it gives me the sense of yellow

Yet there is a brown to it, a hardness and sincerity

that is grand, and the yellowish fruit of it is only hiding it

A rock of stability, which is only sane

Nothing can be that great without some

darkside

Sometimes sweet, sometimes sour

But it's sleekness makes all that go away

Savoring the moment is what makes the mango tango special

Pancake

All heads up examining the ball contact
the hands of the opposing player as it spirals down with force
One player stoops low to the ground
The ball beckons down faster and faster
The player obtains a quizzical look on her face
Again looking up, ball spins and whirls for a thousand revolutions
She lunges forward with the ball still a few feet in front of her
And plunges her body onto the floor
Kneepads grazing the surface
Now sprawled on the floor
she lengthens her hand flat out in front of her
Her head on the ground now, eyes closed,
only trusting her body
3 inches, 2 inches, 1 inch
It touches her fingertip and
soars up higher than the net, as the force rushes through her hand
Just enough for her team to pass it up, and bash it down
She hears 1 clap, 5 claps, soon too many to cipher
She glances over and smiles
25, 22

Rhea Madhogarhia

Lamplight

It sits still in my room
Never being bothered
Until it is dark and still
It lights up my place
And brings joy to my face
Like a firefly in the pitch black of night
Giving joy to children and light for the animals
It came from our ancestors as a blazing hot glow
But this fire has evolved through decades
And is now sitting on my shelf
With a shiny base and stem
That's hot to the touch
Hot enough that it doesn't burn you
But instead brings you warmth when near
It is not an object of destruction or heaviness,
But an object of light, in many more ways than one
For it is the lamplight that rides next to my bed

1. I think that I am best at using and incorporating imagery in my poems. I use similes, metaphors and sensory detail the best. I realized that I like to describe stuff in a fun and creative way like in my grapefruit poem, I used sensory detail and a metaphor in the same line when I said, “ enclosing teardrops of bittersweet”. I was not only describing the looks and the taste of the grapefruit but also comparing it to a teardrop. Sometimes I think that metaphors are more sophisticated because it is not obviously pointing out what you are referring to but it is still clear. I think I use similes just as well because they are easier to incorporate or when I think I am writing a metaphor it turns out that it's a simile instead. Sometimes that I have used similes is in my swan poem when I wrote “It sits like a pearl in the sea”. I like to use similes because they add some fun to our poems and lets people see a simple object in a way they never thought they would've.

2. One tool that I didn't use as much as I should have is compression. When I am writing I find that making complete thoughts leaves people with a satisfied idea in their mind. When I take a word out of a sentence such as them or a, it could sometimes change the meaning of the whole line, so whenever I see a line that could be compressed, I do it. But if it is a sentence which has a few tiny words but it's still a meaningful line where every word has a purpose, then I will have no reason to change it. I think compressing your poem may sometimes compress your ideas and make you want to change things unnecessarily, at least for me it does. That is why I don't think compression is that useful.

Another thing that I didn't use that much was alliteration or word play. When I think of word play, I think of a really fun poem or line that adds some humor or lightheartedness to it. When I start to explain something it is not in a cheery fashion or in a sad way but more of a deep explanation that is read with heart. I don't think wordplay necessarily fits with my types of poem but it is still something I try to do sometimes. If I wrote the cliché line, “as dark as night”, I would not want to write “a dark dusk”, because it loses the meaning and it doesn't fit well. If I have to go out of my way to find a way to use wordplay it will be forced and will not flow well with the poem. I think that when you read a poem it should have a certain rhythm and flow to it.

3. One thing that I have realized about myself as a poet is that I don't tend to write necessarily happy or upbeat poems. My poems aren't sad or depressing, it's just that they have deep meanings and a more slow and meaningful rhythm. I write about happy topics but I don't use words that are usually associated with “happy”. I tend to write those typical lines that use lines like “I stepped into the darkness” or another (I'll use the word again) cliché line like that because I feel that I need to be poetic but I've realized that any series of phrases can really be a poem. For example the poem of all made up words, “The Loch Ness Monster's Song”. I think I have started away from doing that type of writing where everything has to be flowery, like I'm trying too hard for it to be a poem. That doesn't mean that I will stop doing it, but I thought it was interesting how my idea of a poem is completely different from already great poems out there. That is something I have learned about myself writing poetry, and poetry itself.